

DONNOVAN WINT JR.

Software Engineer · Backend Systems · Applied AI & LLM Platforms · Quality Engineering
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer with 7+ years building backend systems and cloud-based platforms on AWS, with hands-on exposure to containerized services, serverless pipelines, and infrastructure-as-code workflows. Deep experience writing and enforcing quality across the full SDLC: API contract validation, integration and regression testing, structured observability, incident detection, and CI/CD pipeline enforcement. Comfortable contributing to platform reliability efforts, supporting QA processes, and helping shape the test strategy that keeps engineering teams shipping with confidence. Recent focus includes applied AI / LLM-powered features and the backend infrastructure that supports them.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (Lambda, S3, CloudFront, SQS/SNS, RDS, EC2, IAM, CloudWatch), Docker, exposure to Kubernetes and Terraform-managed infrastructure, GitHub Actions CI/CD

Quality Assurance & Testing: Test plan authoring, integration testing, functional & regression testing, UAT coordination, API contract validation (Postman/Newman), defect tracking & lifecycle management, SDLC quality gates, QA process implementation

Observability & Incident Quality: Datadog (dashboards, alerting, distributed tracing), SLO/SLI definition, structured logging, MTTR/MTTD reduction, runbook authoring, on-call incident response

Backend & APIs: Node.js, Python, Java (Spring Boot), Ruby, PHP (OOP, PSR), RESTful & GraphQL API design, WebSockets, webhooks, serverless architectures, FastAPI-style service patterns

Data & SQL: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch — schema design, query optimization, indexing, ETL pipelines, high-throughput data modeling

Security & DevSecOps: IAM policy design, secrets management, auth flows (OAuth/OIDC, Auth0), least-privilege patterns, dependency scanning, code review enforcement

Applied AI & LLM: Production RAG pipelines, vector search, LLM API integration (OpenAI, Anthropic, domain-trained models), backend infrastructure for AI/ML workloads

Frontend: React, Next.js, Vue.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind — Core Web Vitals auditing & remediation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NASCAR · Senior Software Engineer / Development Manager *May 2023 – November 2025*

- **Supported operation of** containerized workloads on Kubernetes (Amazon EKS) for NASCAR's digital platforms, assisting with deployment manifests and release processes for services serving millions of monthly users.
- **Established Datadog-based observability** across services — dashboards, alerting, distributed tracing, and SLO tracking — significantly reducing MTTR and providing on-call engineers with actionable, high-signal incident data.
- **Designed and enforced engineering quality standards** across the web team — code review practices, API versioning conventions, GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines — creating a repeatable QA gate before every production release.
- **Authored runbooks and deployment checklists** that standardized release verification, regression checkpoints, and rollback procedures across all platform services.
- **Contributed to Terraform-managed AWS infrastructure** across multiple environments — Lambda functions, SQS/SNS, RDS, and IAM policies — supporting infrastructure-as-code practices and environment parity for reliable test/prod consistency.
- **Designed and deployed serverless AWS Lambda functions** and SQS-backed event pipelines automating content ingestion and processing, improving system reliability and eliminating significant manual operational overhead.

- **Built and maintained Java-based PDF ingestion pipelines** to parse and extract structured race data — driver stats, finishing positions, top speed, average speed, and lap data — from official NASCAR result documents, feeding downstream APIs and analytics platforms.
- **Architected a headless WordPress platform** serving millions of monthly visitors — PHP-driven REST APIs, React front-ends, and high-throughput content delivery — including full API contract definition and cross-browser/cross-device compatibility validation.
- **Built backend data infrastructure and APIs** supporting NASCAR's internal AI initiatives — race analytics and playoff simulation tools — including data pipeline validation and query correctness testing.
- **Rebuilt the MyProfile Rewards platform end-to-end:** Auth0-backed authentication flows, redesigned APIs, and overhauled session/state management — with thorough functional and regression testing across the new system.
- **Integrated Adobe Journey Optimizer** with the headless CMS for real-time marketing automation data feeds; validated data pipeline correctness and delivery reliability end-to-end.

AlphaSense · Senior Software Engineer

Aug 2022 – May 2023

- **Built RESTful APIs** powering enterprise search at scale — the backend infrastructure underpinning AlphaSense Assistant's production RAG system.
- **Designed and validated database schemas** and pipeline architecture supporting high-throughput, low-latency query workloads over structured and unstructured financial data — including indexing correctness verification and performance regression testing.
- **Architected API contracts** for cross-content search blending customers' internal content with AlphaSense's external corpus under strict permissioning and data isolation requirements; authored and executed integration tests verifying data boundary enforcement.
- **Contributed to LLM-powered features** (document summarization, guidance change detection, sentiment shift analysis) — focusing on API surface, data pipeline validation, and integration testing against domain-trained models.
- **Gained exposure to JVM-based data pipeline patterns** within a Java-heavy search infrastructure environment, informing understanding of typed, compiled backend service design and build tooling (Maven/Gradle).
- **Performed systematic Core Web Vitals audits** and resolved frontend performance bottlenecks across the enterprise platform — documented findings, prioritized issues, and verified fixes through structured retesting.

PriceWeber · Senior Software Engineer

Apr 2022 – Aug 2022

- **Delivered custom backend and frontend implementations** for Fortune 500 marketing campaigns with full cross-device and cross-browser compatibility validation.
- **Performed technical audits** across SEO, WCAG accessibility, and Core Web Vitals — produced prioritized defect reports and remediation plans.
- **Built automated marketing data pipelines** using PHP and REST APIs, eliminating significant manual reporting overhead.

Sagefrog Marketing Group · Software Engineer

Jun 2019 – May 2022

- **Architected a decoupled WordPress + Vue.js headless platform** that significantly reduced page load times and enabled API-driven content delivery at scale.
- **Led architecture and delivery of 30+ enterprise B2B web platforms** — consistently achieving 90+ Lighthouse performance scores through structured performance and quality auditing.
- **Established coding standards and structured code review practices;** mentored junior and mid-level developers on testing discipline and quality ownership.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Information Technology — Penn State Abington

Certifications: Responsive Web Design · Front-End Development Libraries (freeCodeCamp)